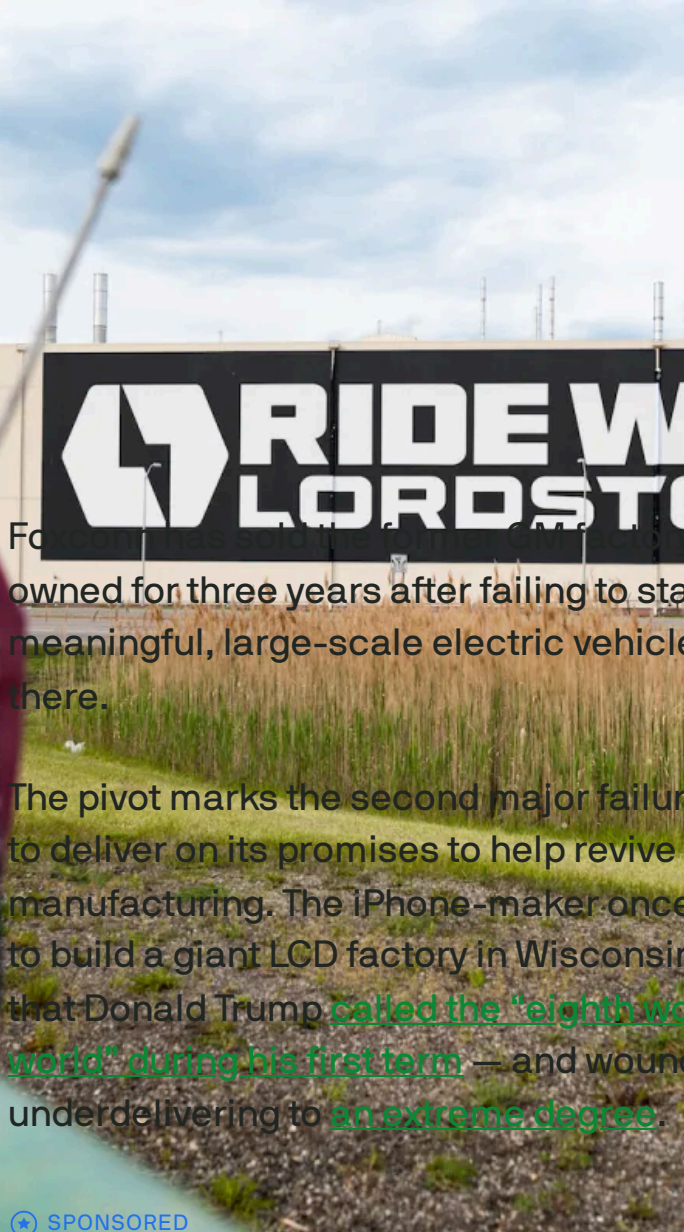


Advertisement

TRANSPORTATION



**Foxconn sells former GM
factory to mystery buyer
after failing to make EVs**



Foxconn says the buyer is an “existing business partner” named “Crescent Dune LLC,” an entity that was created in Delaware just 12 days ago, according to records filed with the state. Matt Dewine, a spokesperson for Foxconn, declined to say more about the buyer.

The pivot marks the second major failure of Foxconn to deliver on its promises to help revive U.S. manufacturing. The iPhone-maker once promised to build a giant LCD factory in Wisconsin — a project that Donald Trump [called the “eighth wonder of the world” during his first term](#) — and wound up underdelivering to [an extreme degree](#).

SPONSORED



Just launched: Lovart, the AI design agent building entire campaigns in 3 minutes

Sponsored by Lovart

Foxconn says the buyer is an “existing business partner” named “Crescent Dune LLC,” an entity that was created in Delaware just 12 days ago, according to records filed with the state. Matt Dewine, a spokesperson for Foxconn, declined to say more about the buyer.

Foxconn sold the factory and land for around \$88 million and machinery and equipment from its EV subsidiaries for around \$287 million, Taiwan stock exchange filings show.

A Foxconn representative told [Automotive News](#) the company will remain “involved in the manufacturing

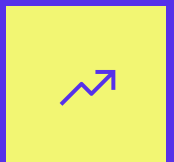
TEC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion

of products for customers at the Lordstown facility” and claimed it is “committed to customers and suppliers” in the automotive industry. But The Wall Street Journal [reported Monday](#) that Foxconn now plans to build AI servers at the factory. Dewine did not immediately respond to a request for comment on the report.

Foxconn announced the deal to buy the former GM plant in 2021 for \$230 million, when it was still owned by EV startup Lordstown Motors. At the time, Foxconn Chairman Young Liu said it was going to be the “most important electric vehicle manufacturing and R&D hub in North America.”

While Foxconn was developing EVs of its own in Asia, it was also focused on contract manufacturing in the United States. And, in short order, three of the electric vehicle companies Foxconn hoped would occupy the factory went bankrupt.

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

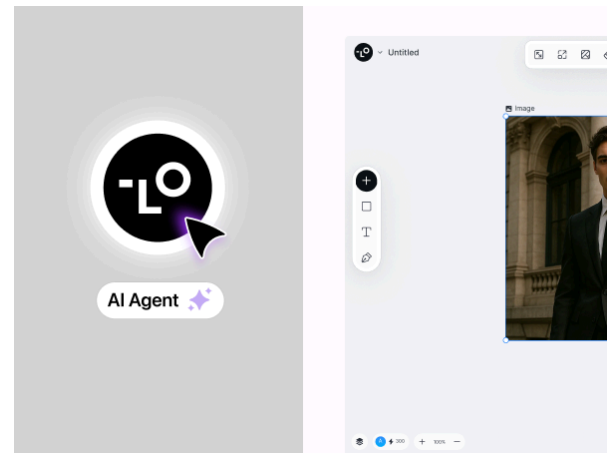
San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Foxconn actually built a few EVs at the factory for the now-defunct Lordstown Motors. But the

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren’t even dating apps

Sponsored by Lovart



SPONSORED

Just launched: Lovart, the AI design agent building entire campaigns in 3 minutes

Taiwanese electronics giant wound up in a bitter fight with that troubled EV startup. Lordstown Motors filed for bankruptcy in June 2023, and accused Foxconn — which had become an investor in the startup — of “starving it of cash,” and said it “maliciously and in bad faith destroyed that business.”

Foxconn also took a flier on a small EV startup called IndiEV, claiming it would build its electric SUV at the Ohio factory. IndiEV filed for bankruptcy in [October 2023](#) with less than \$3 million in the bank. Foxconn was supposed to [build EVs for Fisker Inc.](#) as well. Fisker [filed for bankruptcy in June 2024](#).

A fourth company, Monarch Tractor, has [not had much of an impact](#), with Foxconn making no more than a few hundred electric tractors. Monarch’s CEO, Praveen Penmetsa, did not respond to an emailed request for comment about whether its tractors will continue to be built in Ohio.

Topics: [electric vehicles](#) [EVs](#) [Foxconn](#)

[Transportation](#)



Sean O'Kane

Sr. Reporter, Transportation | [X](#)

Sean O’Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology of the...

[View Bio](#) >

———— KEEP READING ————



f X in   

Lordstown Motors in talks to sell its 6.2M-square-foot factory to Taiwan’s Foxconn

Aria Alamalhodaei — 7:05 AM PDT · September 30, 2021

IMAGE CREDITS:

MEGAN JELINGER / AFP / GETTY IMAGES

EV startup Lordstown Motors made headlines when it purchased a 6.2 million-square-foot factory from General Motors in 2019. Now, it looks like the strapped-for-cash startup will likely sell that facility to Taiwan’s Foxconn Technology Group.

The news was first [reported by Bloomberg](#), who said unnamed sources suggested the deal could close as early as this week. Lordstown executives had said during a second-quarter earnings call that the company was in “serious discussions” with partners to lease the northeast Ohio facility to other companies, so news of the sale isn’t a total surprise.

Advertisement

[Lordstown will deliver its Endurance truck to ‘select early customers’ early next year](#)

While financial details of the transaction were not disclosed, Lordstown would reportedly operate in the facility in parallel with Foxconn — an arrangement that could, in the end, be a net benefit for the beleaguered EV maker, which would receive both a cash injection and Foxconn’s mass-manufacturing expertise.

Foxconn, though best known for manufacturing Apple’s iPhone, has made major strides to enter the electric vehicle manufacturing market over the past few years. The company has inked deals with [EV startup Fisker](#) to co-develop and manufacture a new electric vehicle, and Foxconn will also start manufacturing up to 50,000 vehicles at a Thailand factory in partnership with [Thai oil supplier PTT PLC](#).

Foxconn’s ambitions don’t end there: the manufacturer envisions itself as becoming a contract manufacturer for automakers, and it formed a joint venture with Chinese automaker Zhejiang Geely Holding Group to provide design, R&D and manufacturing to OEMs looking to sell EVs.

Newsletters

[See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).





Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

[Foxconn, Geely team up to build electric, autonomous and shared vehicles for automakers](#)

Lordstown is aiming to deliver the first models of its flagship electric truck “Endurance” to a small group of customers early next year. The company named a new chief executive in August, after [former CEO Steve Burns resigned](#) following concerns over the company's coffers. CEO Dan Ninivaggi was instated scarcely a year after Lordstown announced its \$1.6 billion SPAC merger.

At their 52-week highs, Lordstown shares hit \$31.80 apiece. They're now trading at \$7.88.

TechCrunch has reached out to Lordstown and Foxconn for comment and will update the story if they respond.

Topics: [electric vehicles](#) [EVs](#) [Foxconn](#)

[foxconn-technology-group](#) [Lordstown Motors](#)



Aria Alamalhodaei

Reporter, Space and Defense |

Aria Alamalhodaei covers the space and defense industries at TechCrunch. Previously, she covered the public utilities...

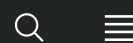
[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING



Latest
Startups
Venture
Apple
Security
AI
Apps

Events
Podcasts
Newsletters



Kirsten Korosec — 4:56 PM PDT · September 30, 2021

Foxconn will build electric vehicles for Lordstown Motors as well as its other partner [Fisker](#) Inc. at a former GM factory in Ohio, under an agreement announced Thursday.

Lordstown Motors, the beleaguered electric vehicle company that became publicly traded via a merger with a special purpose acquisition company, said Thursday it reached a nonbinding agreement with Foxconn to sell its 6.2-million-square-foot factory. Lordstown purchased the factory in 2019 from General Motors.

Under the agreement, which has yet to close, Foxconn will pay \$230 million for the facility. The deal excludes certain assets such as Lordstown's hub motor assembly line, battery module and packing line assets and certain intellectual property rights. Foxconn will also buy \$50 million of Lordstown common stock.

The companies said they will negotiate a contract manufacturing agreement for Foxconn to assemble Lordstown's Endurance full-size pickup truck at the facility. Reaching a contract manufacturing agreement is a condition to closing the facility purchase. The parties have agreed to explore licensing arrangements for additional pickup truck programs.

The deal comes at a critical moment for Lordstown Motors, a cash-strapped startup turned SPAC that had a string of missteps earlier this year. In August, the company [hired Daniel A. Ninivaggi](#), a longtime automotive executive and former head of Carl C. Icahn's holding company, as CEO and a board member. The appointment came after months of tumult at the company, including the resignation of its founder and [CEO Steve Burns](#). [CFO Julio Rodriguez resigned](#) following a disappointing first-quarter earnings report that revealed the company was consuming more capital than expected and

Latest in Transportation

[See More](#)

TRANSPORTATION



Federal regulators give Zoox an exemption for its custom-built robotaxis

Kirsten Korosec - 12 hours ago

TRANSPORTATION



Jeh Aerospace nets \$11M to scale the commercial aircraft supply chain in India

Jagmeet Singh - 2 days ago

TRANSPORTATION



Foxconn sells former GM factory to mystery buyer after failing to make EVs

Sean O'Kane - 2 days ago

unable to reach previously [forecasted production numbers](#) for its electric Endurance pickup truck.

The goal of the partnership, the companies said in its announcement, is to present both Lordstown Motors and Foxconn with increased market opportunities in scalable electric vehicle production in North America. That includes Foxconn's existing partnership with EV company Fisker Inc. (Lordstown and Fisker are separate companies and have no connection.)

In May, Fisker signed an agreement with Foxconn to co-develop and manufacture a new electric vehicle under a program called Project PEAR. Production on the Project PEAR car, which stands for Personal Electric Automotive Revolution, will be sold under the Fisker brand name in North America, Europe, China and India. Pre-production is expected to begin in the U.S. by the end of 2023 and will then ramp up into the following year, Fisker told TechCrunch in an [an August interview](#).



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#)

Fisker didn't reveal the U.S. manufacturing location. The final decision would be Foxconn's, Fisker noted at the time.

Fisker issued a statement Thursday welcoming the news from Foxconn.

"Achieving key program objectives such as time to market, access to a well-developed supplier ecosystem and overall cost targets were all important factors in the decision to locate manufacturing in Ohio," Henrik Fisker said in an emailed statement. "Since signing the agreement with Foxconn earlier this year, we have been working together intensively on all aspects of Project PEAR including design, engineering, supply chain and manufacturing. Fisker's commitment to volume manufacturing in the United States takes another important step forward today with the signing of this agreement."

Fisker also has another vehicle program in the works with a different contract manufacturer. The Fisker Ocean SUV will be assembled by automotive contract manufacturer Magna Steyr in Europe. The start of production is still on track to begin in November 2022, the company reiterated in its second-quarter earnings call. Deliveries will begin in Europe and the United States in late 2022, with a plan to reach production capacity of more than 5,000 vehicles per month during 2023. Deliveries to customers in China are also expected to begin in 2023.

Topics: [Apple](#) [electric vehicles](#) [Fisker](#) [Foxconn](#)

[Lordstown Motors](#) [Transportation](#)





Kirsten Korosec

Transportation Editor | [X](#) [f](#) [in](#)

Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING



IMAGE CREDITS: LORDSTOWN MOTORS

TRANSPORTATION



Lordstown Motors begins shipping its Foxconn-made EV pickup trucks

Kirsten Korosec — 7:39 AM PST · November 29, 2022

Lordstown Motors has starting shipping its all-electric Endurance pickup trucks manufactured by Foxconn, a milestone that seemed impossible earlier this year.

TC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Lordstown Motors, which has experienced investigations, executive upheaval and a shortage of capital, said Tuesday that its full-sized EV truck received full homologation with certification from both the EPA and CARB that clears the way for the company to start customer sales.

The first batch of 500 EV pickups, made at an Ohio factory now owned by Taiwanese hardware manufacturing company Foxconn, are on their way to fleet customers, according to the company. The announcement sent shares of Lordstown Motors stock up 3.79%.

Lordstown Motors has moved from one dramatic event to another in its short life as a company. Workhorse Group founder and former CEO Steve Burns started Lordstown Motors in 2018. The startup immediately gained attention for its deal with GM to buy the legacy automaker's soon-to-be-shuttered factory in Lordstown, Ohio. GM invested \$75 million into Lordstown.

The company became a political tool at times; the unveiling of its Endurance pickup truck geared toward contractors was largely [used as a campaign stop](#) for then-Vice President Mike Pence. Lordstown also sustained a series of setbacks, which seemed to ramp up after it became a publicly traded company through a merger with a special purpose acquisition company.

In March 2021, Hindenburg Research, the short-seller firm whose report on Nikola Motor [led to an SEC investigation](#) and the resignation (and ultimately the indictment) of its founder, issued a report [disputing Lordstown's claims](#) it had booked 100,000 preorders for its truck. The firm also alleged that Burns paid consultants for every truck preorder as early as 2016 while he was leading Workhorse.

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

By summer 2021, Burns and [CFO Julio Rodriguez had resigned](#), the company warned it was running low on capital and investors learned it was being [investigated by the Department of Justice](#).



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#)

Foxconn, best known as the maker of Apple's iPhone, came to the rescue in September 2021 and bought the Lordstown factory [for \\$230 million](#). Foxconn also agreed to manufacture the pickup truck for Lordstown under a joint venture contract. Foxconn increased its investment in Lordstown Motors in November 2022 by buying \$170 million in common stock and newly created preferred shares.

Foxconn holds all of Lordstown's outstanding preferred stock and 18.3% of its common stock on a pro forma basis.

Topics: [electric vehicles](#) [Foxconn](#) [Lordstown Motors](#)

[Transportation](#) [transportation](#)



Kirsten Korosec

Transportation Editor | [X](#) [f](#) [in](#)

Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

View Bio >

Loading the next article

